Hurricane Checklist

From the free guide at https://jaechung-glitch.github.io/bugout/guides/what-to-do-during-a-hurricane/, which lists its sources (National Weather Service, National Hurricane Center and American Red Cross guidance). Updated November 12, 2026.

General safety information, not medical advice or a substitute for training. In an emergency, call 911.

Before the hurricane

- Find out whether you live in an evacuation zone, and plan where you'd go and how.
- Keep your gas tank at least half full during hurricane season.
- Cover windows. Permanent storm shutters are best; otherwise 5/8-inch exterior-grade or marine plywood cut to fit, the National Weather Service says.
- Bring in or tie down outdoor furniture, grills and anything the wind could throw.
- Stock at least 3 days of water (1 gallon per person per day) and food, plus medicines, flashlights, batteries, a radio and a first-aid kit. Plan for two weeks without power.
- Charge phones and power banks, and get cash.
- Bring pets inside and pack food, carriers and records for them.

During the hurricane

- **If ordered to evacuate, leave immediately.** See what to do when told to evacuate.
- **If you stay,** go to a small interior room, closet or hallway on the lowest floor, with as many walls between you and the outside as possible.
- Stay away from windows, skylights and glass doors.
- If the eye passes over, expect a short calm, then winds from the opposite direction. Stay inside.
- Keep a battery or hand-crank radio on for updates.
- If water starts rising in your home, move to a higher floor and call 911 if you can.

After the hurricane

- Return home only when officials say it's safe.
- Stay off flooded roads and washed-out bridges. Six inches of moving water can knock you down; 12 inches can carry away most cars.
- Stay away from downed power lines. Walk around the outside of your home to check for loose lines, gas leaks and damage before going in.
- Stay out of a building if you smell gas or floodwater surrounds it.
- Use flashlights, not candles. Turn the flashlight on before you go into a dark building, since a spark could ignite leaking gas.
- Never run a generator in your home or garage. See our power outage checklist for the carbon monoxide rules.
- Follow any boil-water notice, and throw out food that's been in floodwater or without power too long.

Hurricane checklist

- [ ] Know your evacuation zone, route and destination
- [ ] Gas tank at least half full
- [ ] Water: 1 gallon per person per day, at least 3 days
- [ ] Food that needs no cooking, and a manual can opener
- [ ] Medicines and a first-aid kit
- [ ] Flashlights, extra batteries and a battery or hand-crank radio
- [ ] Charged phones and power banks
- [ ] Cash
- [ ] Copies of insurance papers and IDs in a waterproof bag
- [ ] Window coverings ready
- [ ] Outdoor furniture and grills brought in or tied down
- [ ] Pet food, carriers and records